Note

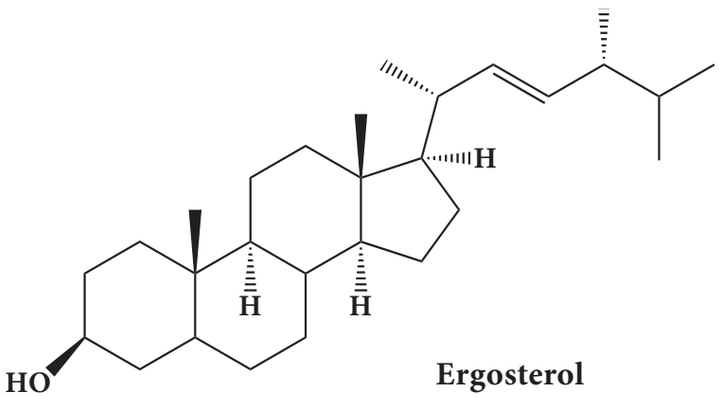
Cholesterol, is not found in plant cell and it is abundantly found in animal cell membrane and it helps stiffen the membrane

DO YOU KNOW?

Obesity is excess body fat that has accumulated to the extent that may have a negative effect on health. People are generally considered obese when their body mass index (BMI), is in the range 25-30kg/m^2. BMI is calculated by dividing a person's weight by the square of the person's eight. It is most commonly caused by a combination of excessive food intake, lack of physical acitivity, and genetic susceptibility. Over weight is associated with various diseases like cardiovascular diseases, diabetes mellitus type 2, obstructive sleep apnea, osteoarthritis and asthma

ii. Ergosterol

Ergosterol is a sterol found in cell membranes of fungi and protozoa, serving many of the same functions that cholesterol serves in animal cells. Ergosterol is a pro-vitamin form of vitamin D_2; exposure to ultraviolet (UV) light causes a chemical reaction that produces vitamin D_2.



Ergosterol

Figure 6.18 Structure of Ergosterol

YOU KNOW?

As fungi and protozoa cannot survive without ergosterol, the enzymes that synthesis ergosterol have become important targets for developing drugs against them.

iii. Biological function:

- Ergosterol is a biological precursor of vitamin D2 (ergocalciferol). In mushroom cultivation, after harvest, mushrooms are irradiated to increase their Vitamin D content.

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